

BobaLink Browser Extension

User Guide

Version: 1.0.0

Date: 2026-06-06

Classification: Internal

Table of Contents

1. Getting Started

2. Using BobaLink

3. Configuration

4. Troubleshooting

5. Tips and Tricks

6. Frequently Asked Questions

1. Getting Started

1.1 What is BobaLink?

BobaLink is a browser extension that bridges the gap between finding torrents and sending them to your private server. It automatically detects magnet links and `.torrent` files on any website visit, and with a single click, sends them to your Boba server or directly to qBittorrent.

Key Features:

Feature	Description
Automatic Detection	Magnet links and <code>.torrent</code> files are detected as you browse. No manual action is required.
One-Click Send	Right-click any detected torrent and send it immediately.
Tab Group Batching	Send all torrents from an entire tab group at once.
Offline Queue	Failed sends are automatically retried when your server comes back online.
Real-time Progress	Badge on the toolbar icon shows download status at a glance.
Auto-Discovery	BobaLink can find your Boba server automatically on your first visit.
Cross-Browser	Works on Chrome, Firefox, Opera, and Yandex Browser.

Requirement	Details
Browser	Chrome 88+, Firefox 109+, Opera 74+, or Yandex 13.10+
Boba Server (recommended)	Docker container running on your local network or a remote server
qBitTorrent (direct mode)	qBitTorrent 4.4+ with WebUI enabled and accessible
Network	Your browser must be able to reach the Boba server HTTPS
Operating System	Windows 10+, macOS 11+, or any modern Linux distribution

1.3 Installation

BobaLink can be installed from your browser's official extension store or manually. For more detailed instructions, see the [Installation Guide](#).

Quick Install:

Browser	Store Link	Method
Chrome	Chrome Web Store	Click "Add to Chrome"
Firefox	addons.mozilla.org	Click "Add to Firefox"
Opera	Opera Addons	Click "Add to Opera"
Yandex	Manual only	See Installation Guide

Mode	Description	Best For
Boba Server (recommended)	Connects through a Boba orchestration server that proxies requests to qBitTorrent	Users running qBitTorrent on multiple devices or users who want to track download progress
qBitTorrent Direct	Connects directly to qBitTorrent's WebUI API	Users who want to use qBitTorrent without the Boba layer

Step 2: Server Discovery (Boba Mode)

If you selected Boba Server mode, BobaLink will attempt to automatically discover your Boba server.

1. Click "**Discover Servers**" on the welcome page.
2. BobaLink will scan common local addresses (`boba.local:8443` , `boba.local:8443` , `boba.local:8443`).
3. Discovered servers will appear in a list, ranked by response speed.
4. Select your server from the list and click "**Connect**".

If auto-discovery does not find your server:

1. Click "**Manual Configuration**".
2. Enter your Boba server URL (e.g., `https://192.168.1.100:8443`).
3. Enter your API key (obtain from your Boba server admin).
4. Click "**Test Connection**" to verify.

Step 3: qBitTorrent Direct Setup

If you selected qBitTorrent Direct mode:

1. Enter your qBitTorrent WebUI URL (e.g., `https://192.168.1.100:8080`).

Icon State	Meaning	Action Needed
Green dot	Connected to server	None
Blue spinner	Connecting / sending	Wait
Orange dot	Queued items pending	None — will retry automatically
Red dot	Connection error	Check server or credentials
Gray dot	Not configured	Open Options and connect to server

To check connection status:

1. Click the BobaLink icon in the toolbar.
2. The header shows the current connection state.
3. Click the refresh icon to force a health check.

2. Using BobaLink

2.1 Browsing and Detection

BobaLink automatically detects torrents as you browse the web. No manual a

What Gets Detected

1. Scans all `<a>` elements on the page for magnet or `.torrent` links.
2. Watches for dynamically loaded content (single-page apps, infinite scrolling).
3. Parses magnet URIs to extract metadata (name, trackers, size).
4. Displays a subtle badge count on the BobaLink toolbar icon showing the number of links found on the current page.

Privacy Note: Detection happens entirely within your browser. No data is sent to the server unless you explicitly choose to send a torrent.

Visual Indicators on Web Pages

BobaLink does not modify web pages by default. If you enable the optional "Visual Indicators" setting:

- Magnet links get a subtle green underline.
- `.torrent` links get a subtle blue underline.
- Hovering shows a tooltip with the torrent name and size.

To enable: Open Options → Detection → Check "Highlight torrents on page"

2.2 Sending Magnet Links

Once BobaLink has detected magnet links on a page, you have several ways to send them:

Method 1: Context Menu (Right-Click)

1. Right-click on any magnet link on the page.
2. Select "**Send Magnet to Boba**" from the context menu.
3. The link is immediately sent to your configured server.

2. All detected torrents on the current page are sent automatically.

Method 4: Send All on Page

1. Click the BobaLink icon in the toolbar.
2. Click "**Send All**" to send every detected torrent on the page.

Send Confirmation:

After sending, you'll see:

- A browser notification (if enabled): "Torrent Sent — {name} added to download"
- The badge count updates to reflect sent items
- If the send fails, the item is added to the offline queue for automatic retry

2.3 Sending .torrent Files

When BobaLink detects a link to a `.torrent` file (not a magnet link), it can send the file.

Context Menu Method

1. Right-click on a `.torrent` file link.
2. Select "**Download .torrent to Boba**" from the context menu.
3. BobaLink downloads the file (up to 10 MB), parses it, and sends it to your client.

Popup Method

1. Click the BobaLink icon.
2. `.torrent` file links appear in the detected list with a file icon.
3. Select and send as with magnet links

Setting Up Tab Groups

1. In Chrome, right-click any tab and select "**Add tab to new group**".
2. Give the group a name and choose a color.
3. Add multiple torrent pages to the group.

Sending a Tab Group

Method 1 — Popup:

1. Click the BobaLink icon.
2. Click the "**Tab Groups**" tab in the popup.
3. You'll see all your tab groups listed.
4. Click "**Send**" next to the group you want to process.

Method 2 — Context Menu:

1. Right-click on any tab in the group.
2. Select "**Send Tab Group to Boba**".

Method 3 — Keyboard Shortcut:

1. Ensure a tab within the target group is active.
2. Press `Ctrl+Shift+G` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd+Shift+G` (macOS).

What Happens:

1. BobaLink scans every tab in the group.
2. All detected torrents are collected.
3. Duplicates across tabs are automatically removed.
4. The unique torrents are sent as a batch.
5. A summary notification appears: "Batch Complete — 12 torrents sent, 0 fa

Column	Description
Name	Torrent display name
Status	Pending / Retrying / Failed / Dead Letter
Attempts	Number of send attempts
Next Retry	Countdown to next automatic retry
Actions	Retry now / Remove

Queue Actions

Action	How To	Result
Retry now	Click the circular arrow icon	Immediate retry
Remove	Click the X icon	Item removed from queue
Retry all failed	Click " Retry All Failed "	Retries all items in failed state
Clear queue	Click " Clear Queue " → Confirm	Removes all items from queue

Queue Behavior

- **Automatic retry:** Items are retried with exponential backoff (5s, 10s, 20s, 40s, 80s, 160s)
- **Max retries:** Default is 5 attempts. After that, the item moves to "Dead Letter"
- **Dead letter items:** These require manual intervention. You can retry the item manually or remove it from the queue.

Color	Meaning
Green	All clear — connected, no pending items
Blue	Currently sending torrent(s)
Orange	Items in queue, waiting for retry
Red	Connection error or send failures
Gray	Extension not configured

Popup Progress View

1. Click the BobaLink icon.
2. Click the "**Downloads**" tab.
3. If connected to Boba Server with SSE enabled, you'll see:

Column	Description
Name	Torrent name
Progress	Visual progress bar + percentage
Speed	Download speed (e.g., "5.2 MB/s")
ETA	Estimated time remaining
Status	Downloading / Seeding / Paused / Error

Action	Windows/Linux	macOS
Send all torrents on current page	Ctrl+Shift+B	Cmd+Shif
Open BobaLink popup	Ctrl+Shift+L	Cmd+Shif
Send current tab's group	Ctrl+Shift+G	Cmd+Shif
Scan page (without sending)	Ctrl+Shift+S	Cmd+Shif

To customize shortcuts:

Browser	Path
Chrome	chrome://extensions/shortcuts
Firefox	about:addons → Gear icon → Manage Extension Shortcuts
Opera	opera://extensions/shortcuts
Yandex	browser://extensions/shortcuts

3. Configuration

3.1 Options Page Walkthrough

Setting	Description
Connection Mode	Boba Server or qBitTorrent Direct
Server URL	Base URL of your server
Authentication	API Key, Username/Password, or Custom Header
Test Connection	Verifies connectivity and shows server version
Connection Timeout	Seconds to wait for API responses
Health Check Interval	Seconds between automatic health checks

Download Preferences Tab

Configure default behavior when sending torrents.

Setting	Description
Default Category	qBitTorrent category for new torrents
Default Tags	Comma-separated tags (e.g., <code>browser, auto</code>)
Default Save Path	Override download directory
Pause After Add	Add torrents in paused state
Skip Hash Check	Skip initial hash verification
Sequential Download	Download pieces in order

Setting	Description
Max Queue Size	Maximum items to retain
Max Retries	Attempts before dead-letter
Base Retry Delay	Initial retry wait time (seconds)
Max Retry Delay	Longest retry wait time (seconds)

Notification Settings Tab

Configure when BobaLink shows browser notifications.

Event	Default	Description
Send Success	Enabled	Toast when torrent is successfully sent
Send Failed	Enabled	Toast when send fails (immediately, no
Batch Complete	Enabled	Summary after tab group batch send
Queue Retry	Disabled	Toast on each retry attempt

Detection Settings Tab

Configure torrent detection behavior.

Setting	Description
---------	-------------

Setting	Options
Theme	System / Light / Dark
Show Badge	Show numeric badge on toolbar icon
Badge Color	Custom colors for each state

Security Settings Tab

Configure security preferences.

Setting	Description
Require Password	Ask for password on browser startup
Auto-Lock	Lock credentials after minutes of inactivity
HTTPS Only	Refuse non-HTTPS server URLs
Certificate Pinning	Pin expected server certificate

3.2 Server Settings in Detail

Switching Between Boba and qBitTorrent Direct

1. Open Options → Server Settings.
2. Change the **Connection Mode** dropdown.

3.3 Download Preferences

Categories

Categories help organize torrents in qBitTorrent. To set up:

1. Open Options → Download Preferences.
2. Enter a default category name (e.g., `movies` , `tv-shows`).
3. The category must already exist in qBitTorrent, or qBitTorrent will create it (starting from qBitTorrent 4.0.0 on version).

To manage categories in qBitTorrent:

1. Open qBitTorrent WebUI.
2. Go to **View** → **Categories**.
3. Add or edit categories with optional default save paths.

Tags

Tags provide additional metadata. Multiple tags are comma-separated:

```
browser , auto , hd
```

These appear in qBitTorrent's Tags column and can be used for filtering and a

Download Path Override

To save torrents to a specific directory (overriding qBitTorrent's default):

1. Open Options → Download Preferences.

Browser	Steps
Chrome	Click the lock icon in the address bar → Site settings → Notifications
Firefox	Click the permissions icon in the address bar → Allow notifications
Opera	Settings → Privacy & Security → Site settings → Notifications

3.5 Security Settings

Password Protection

For shared computers, enable password protection:

1. Open Options → Security Settings.
2. Enable "**Require Password on Startup**".
3. Enter and confirm a password.
4. Click "**Save**".

On the next browser startup, BobaLink will prompt for the password before d
The password is never stored — only used to derive the encryption key.

Forgot Password? There is no recovery. You must reset the extension (which
and reconfigure.

4. Troubleshooting

1. Check the server URL

- Open Options → Server Settings.
- Verify the URL is correct (e.g., `https://192.168.1.100:8443`).
- Common mistake: Using `http://` instead of `https://` .
- Common mistake: Wrong port number.

2. Test from the browser directly

- Open a new tab and navigate to `{your-server-url}/api/v1/health`
- You should see a JSON response with version information.
- If you get a certificate error, your browser may not trust the server's certificate.

3. Check credentials

- Open Options → Server Settings.
- Click "**Test Connection**".
- If it returns "Authentication failed," verify your API key or username/password.
- For qBitTorrent Direct, ensure the WebUI is enabled in qBitTorrent settings.

4. Check network connectivity

- Ensure your computer can reach the server:

```
bash ping 192.168.1.100 curl -k https://192.168.1.100:8443
```

5. Check firewall rules

- Ensure port 8443 (Boba) or 8080 (qBitTorrent) is open.
- If using Docker, ensure the container port is mapped:

```
bash docker ps # Look for 0.0.0.0:8443->8443/tcp
```

6. Check certificate validity

- Self-signed certificates may be rejected.
- In Options → Security, you may need to disable "HTTPS Only" temporarily (not recommended for production).

2. The link is in an iframe

- Content inside iframes may not be accessible.
- Open the iframe content directly in a new tab if possible.

3. The link is not a standard `<a>` tag

- Some sites use JavaScript click handlers instead of actual links.
- Try right-clicking and selecting "Copy link address," then check if it's

4. The page uses a non-standard magnet format

- Some sites abbreviate or encode magnet links differently.
- Manually copy the link and paste it into qBitTorrent.

5. Extension permissions

- Ensure BobaLink has permission to access the site:
 - Click the lock icon in the address bar.
 - Check if extensions are allowed.
 - Try clicking the BobaLink icon and granting permission when prompted.

4.3 "Send Failed" Errors

Symptom	You click "Send" but get a "Send Failed" notification or the link is not in the queue.
---------	--

Common causes:

1. Server is temporarily unreachable

- Check if your Boba/qBitTorrent server is running.

4. Invalid torrent data

- The magnet link may be malformed.
- The `.torrent` file may be corrupted or not a valid torrent.

5. Rate limiting

- If sending many torrents rapidly, you may hit rate limits.
- Wait a moment and retry.

4.4 "Extension Not Working on Site X"

Symptom	BobaLink doesn't detect anything on a specific website
---------	--

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check if the site requires login

- Some torrent sites only show links to logged-in users.
- Ensure you're logged in and the links are visible.

2. JavaScript-rendered content

- Some sites render all content via JavaScript.
- Try waiting a few seconds after the page appears "loaded."
- Scroll down to trigger lazy loading.

3. Content Security Policy (CSP) restrictions

- Some sites have strict CSP headers that limit extension functionality.
- BobaLink respects these restrictions and will not inject scripts on such sites.

4. Extension conflict

- Other extensions may interfere

4.5 Badge Shows Error

Badge Color	Meaning	Solution
Red	Connection error	Check server status and credentials
Red with "E"	Extension error	Check the popup for details; reload extension
Orange	Queue has retrying items	Normal — wait for automatic retry
Gray	Not configured	Open Options and set up your account
No badge	No torrents on current page	Normal — browse to a page with torrents

To reload the extension:

Browser	Steps
Chrome	<code>chrome://extensions</code> → Toggle BobaLink off and on
Firefox	<code>about:addons</code> → BobaLink → Toggle off and on
Opera	<code>opera://extensions</code> → Toggle BobaLink off and on

5. Tips and Tricks

3. **Name groups descriptively:** The group name appears in batch send notifications.
4. **Pre-set categories:** Before sending a group, configure the default category. The group will use that category.

5.2 Keyboard Shortcut Cheat Sheet

Print this section for quick reference:

Action	Shortcut
Send all torrents on current page	Ctrl+Shift+B (Cmd+Shift+B Mac)
Open BobaLink popup	Ctrl+Shift+L (Cmd+Shift+L Mac)
Send current tab's group	Ctrl+Shift+G (Cmd+Shift+G Mac)
Scan page (no send)	Ctrl+Shift+S (Cmd+Shift+S Mac)

5.3 Privacy Best Practices

1. **Use HTTPS only:** Always connect to your server over HTTPS. BobaLink supports HTTPS.
2. **Enable password protection:** On shared computers, enable "Require Password" in Security Settings.

5.4 Power User Workflows

Workflow: Nightly Batch Download

1. Throughout the day, add torrent pages to a Chrome tab group named "To D
2. Before bed, press `Ctrl+Shift+G` to send the entire group.
3. Check qBitTorrent in the morning — all downloads are ready.

Workflow: Category-Based Organization

1. In Options → Download Preferences, set categories for different content ty
2. Use qBitTorrent's "Automatic Torrent Management" to auto-move complet
- category.
3. Your downloads are automatically organized into folders.

Workflow: Monitoring Large Batches

1. Enable all notifications in Options → Notification Settings.
2. Send a large tab group batch.
3. Watch browser notifications for real-time status of each torrent.
4. Check the Queue tab for any failures.

6. Frequently Asked Questions

General Questions

Q1: What is BobaLink?

Q3: What browsers are supported?

Chrome 88+, Firefox 109+, Opera 74+, and Yandex Browser 21+. Edge Chromium-based.

Q4: Does BobaLink work on mobile browsers?

No. Mobile browsers (Chrome for Android, Safari for iOS) do not support the Web Worker API that BobaLink requires, particularly the background service worker.

Setup and Configuration

Q5: Do I need the Boba server, or can I use qBitTorrent directly?

You can use either. Boba Server provides additional features like search, metadata, streaming, and auto-discovery. qBitTorrent Direct is simpler and doesn't need any middleware.

Q6: How do I find my Boba server URL?

If Boba is running on your local network, try clicking "Discover Servers". If that doesn't work, check your Docker configuration or ask your server administrator for the IP and port.

The WebUI is qBitTorrent's built-in web interface for remote control. To enable it:

1. Open qBitTorrent → **Tools** → **Options**.
2. Select **Web UI** from the left sidebar.
3. Check "**Web User Interface (Remote control)**".
4. Set a port (default 8080) and authentication.
5. Click **Apply**.

Q9: Can I use BobaLink with multiple servers?

Not simultaneously. BobaLink supports one active server configuration at a time. You can switch between servers in Options → Server Settings, but only one is active.

Q10: How do I change the toolbar icon position?

Click and drag the icon to reposition it in the browser toolbar. On some browsers, you may need to click the extensions icon (puzzle piece) and use the pin option.

Usage Questions

Q11: Does BobaLink automatically download torrents without my permission?

No. BobaLink only detects torrents on the page. Nothing is sent to your storage or downloaded.

The torrent is added to the offline queue. BobaLink will automatically retry when the server comes back online, using exponential backoff.

Q14: How long does the queue retain failed items?

By default, up to 30 days or until 1,000 items accumulate. These limits are configurable → Queue Settings.

Q15: Can I send torrents from private trackers?

Yes, as long as the magnet link or `.torrent` file is accessible. BobaLink will attempt to resolve the source. Note that private tracker torrents may require specific passkeys in the magnet link.

Q16: Does BobaLink work with magnet links that don't have a display name?

Yes. If the `dn` (display name) parameter is missing, BobaLink will show the default interface. The actual torrent name will be resolved by qBitTorrent from the magnet link.

Q17: Can I send the same torrent twice?

BobaLink deduplicates by infohash. If you try to send a torrent that's already in the queue or downloading, it will be skipped with a "duplicate" status.

Privacy and Security

Q19: Does BobaLink collect my browsing data?

No. BobaLink operates entirely locally. It does not send browsing history or torrents to any third party. All communication is directly between your browser and the server.

Q20: How are my credentials stored?

Credentials are encrypted using AES-256-GCM (a military-grade encryption algorithm) using the Web Crypto API. The encryption key is stored only in browser memory and is not persisted.

Q21: What permissions does BobaLink need?

BobaLink uses the `activeTab` permission, which means it only accesses the currently viewing tab and only when you interact with the extension. It does not access browsing history, bookmarks, or other tabs.

Q22: Can someone steal my credentials if they access my computer?

If you enabled password protection, credentials cannot be decrypted without the password. If password protection is disabled, anyone with physical access to your un

Q24: Why are some torrents not detected?

See the "[Torrent Not Detected](#)" troubleshooting section. Common causes include slow page loading, iframe isolation, and non-standard link formats.

Q25: How do I clear the queue?

Open the BobaLink popup → Queue tab → Click "Clear Queue" → Confirm. This will clear all queued items permanently.

Q26: How do I reset BobaLink to defaults?

Open Options → scroll to the bottom → Click "Reset to Defaults" → Confirm. This will reset all settings, credentials, and queue data.

Q27: BobaLink slows down my browser. What can I do?

BobaLink is designed for minimal performance impact. If you experience slowdowns, try the following:

- 1. Disable "Highlight torrents on page" in Options → Detection.*
- 2. Reduce the number of open tabs with detected torrents.*
- 3. Ensure you're using the latest version of BobaLink.*

Q28: How do I report a bug?

If installed from a store (Chrome Web Store, AMO), updates are automatic. If installed from a ZIP file, you must manually download the latest release ZIP and reload the extension.

Q30: Where can I get help?

- *Read this user guide thoroughly.*
- *Check the [Troubleshooting](#) section.*
- *Visit the [GitHub Discussions](#) page.*
- *Join the community [Discord](#)/forum (links on the project website).*

End of User Guide